

HouseholdSpend

Release Notes

What is it?

HouseholdSpend provides current estimates of annual expenditures for 446 variables, spanning 18 categories of goods and services used by Canadian households—everything from fashion apparel and household furnishings to cellphones and charitable donations. This wide-ranging database lets users analyze potential expenditures by both average dollars per household and total dollars spent for any geographic level—from all of Canada to a small trade area—regardless of where the consumer made the purchase. HouseholdSpend is produced annually with household income data from DemoStats and is based on Statistics Canada's Survey of Household Spending.

What's New?

The 2025 update introduces a comprehensive set of new variables that reflect modern consumer behaviour and improve analytical precision. This year, 145 new variables have been added while 648 have been retired. These enhancements allow for deeper insight into household spending patterns and a growing demand for more granular data.

Key Data Insights:

Consumer Goods & Services: Variables capture expenditures on clothing, footwear, accessories, health care products, household furnishings and pet-related goods. This enables more precise segmentation for retailers, service providers, and marketers targeting lifestyle-driven consumer segments.

Housing & Utilities: New variables detail spending on utilities, repairs, renovations and real estate services for both primary and secondary residences. These insights support housing cost analysis and strategic planning for developers, municipalities and energy providers.

Mobility & Recreation: Variables track transportation modes such as ridesharing, leased vehicles, and public transit, alongside recreational spending on sports equipment, live events, and digital entertainment. This helps brands and planners understand how Canadians move, play, and engage with leisure activities.

Financial & Social Contributions: Variables include insurance premiums, pension contributions, charitable donations, and financial services. These additions provide a clearer picture of household financial behaviour and social engagement, supporting financial institutions and policy makers.

Data Vintage

2025

Base Level Geography

Postal code

Variables

446

*To view the complete list of variables please visit:
environicsanalytics.com/en-ca/variables

How is it used?



Analyzing your customers' spending habits can highlight potential cross-promotional opportunities if, for example, the data indicates your customers spend their disposable income disproportionately on a particular category of goods or services.



For a new energy conservation program, a hydro company can use HouseholdSpend to target those PRIZM® segments whose electricity bills accounted for a much higher than average percentage of their total utility bills.



Healthcare providers can use HouseholdSpend to monitor trade areas for purchase trends of prescription and over-the-counter drugs, reflecting an aging population.

Sample questions it can answer

- What product categories do households in my trade area spend the most money on and what percentage of their total spending is associated with those categories?
- How much are my customers spending on average on clothing, rent and groceries?
- Where can I find neighbourhoods with high childcare expenses?
- Are expenditures in my trade area higher, lower or the same as the general population?